years. So how the chief of naval operations was unfamiliar with hailing ships with non-English speaking crews is rather odd (this would not have been a problem for Captain John Paul Jones who had spent time in the navy of Catherine the Great of Russia). Yet, according to Dino Brugioni, Admiral Anderson was briefed in detail on the plan, including the provision of Russian linguists.[83]

The only ship boarded by the US Navy was the *Marucla*, an American-built, Panama-owned, Greek-manned, Lebanese-registered, Soviet-chartered freighter. The ship was stopped and searched on Friday, 26 October by a boarding party from the USS *Joseph P. Kennedy Jr* (which bore the name of the President's brother) and the USS *John R. Pierce*. The boarding party wore formal white dress uniform and did not carry firearms. This was very different from the boarding parties led by Captain Jones, which involved a great many cutlases and flintlocks and a great deal of carnage. The captain of the *Marucla* was Greek; and his manifests were written in Greek (Harold Macmillan might have come in handy at this moment). Linguistics may have constrained the rigour of the boarding party's search of the cargo. Nevertheless, with the boarding of the *Marucla*, President Kennedy had sent a signal about enforcing his quarantine.

The challenges of speaking Russian and reading Greek were as nothing to the problem of communicating with the captains of Soviet submarines. One of the US navy's strategic priorities in the 1960s was Anti-Submarine Warfare to protect the United States from nuclear attack. As noted previously, the Soviet navy had developed ballistic missile-carrying submarines (whose deployment to Cuba had only been cancelled by Khrushchev in September 1962). In October, according to Raymond Garthoff, 'The 97 relatively short-range ballistic missiles on thirty-five Soviet diesel and nuclear submarines were all in Soviet waters and unavailable for early commitment, in addition to being highly vulnerable.'[84] There were also nuclear-armed cruise missile submarines, about which little information has appeared in Western sources.

The Soviets also possessed nuclear-armed torpedoes whose primary mission was to target major warships, especially USN (and Royal Navy) aircraft carriers. The torpedoes could also pose a threat to US ports. And it